

# Ricky Circelli

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## EDUCATION

### University of South Carolina

*Bachelor of Science; Major: Finance (Darla Moore School of Business)*  
*Second Major: Data Science (College of Arts & Sciences); GPA: 4.0*

Columbia, SC

Aug. 2024 – May 2027

- **Honors and Involvement:** President’s List (4x), CSC Academic All-District Team, SEC Academic Honor Roll, South Carolina Honors College
- **Relevant Coursework:** Statistical Methods I & II, Applied Statistics, Computing for Data Science, Data Analytics, Algorithmic Design I, Corporate Financial Analysis
- **Certification:** IBM Data Science Professional Certificate; Microsoft Power BI Data Analyst (PL-300); Claude Certified Architect (CCA-F)

## INTERCOLLEGIATE ATHLETICS

### University of South Carolina Men’s Track & Field

*Student-Athlete*

Columbia, SC

Aug. 2024 - Present

- Balance a 4.0 GPA while competing as an NCAA Division I student-athlete, training approximately 25 hours per week as a middle-distance runner (800m, 1500m)

## EXPERIENCE

### Ally Financial

*Quantitative Modeling Intern*

Charlotte, NC

May 2026 - August 2026

- Developed an end-to-end machine learning credit risk model for auto lending across 200,000+ loan applications and 2,000+ variables, owning the full pipeline from raw data through model evaluation
- Modeled both booked and unbooked application populations, applying reject inference to correct selection bias and improve out-of-sample predictive accuracy
- Engineered features and performed Information Value (IV) analysis and correlation reduction to refine a high-dimensional variable set
- Trained and evaluated XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, and Random Forest models in Python and Snowflake, validating performance with AUC, KS, log loss, calibration, and SHAP explainability

### Varsity Stack

*Founder*

Columbia, SC

February 2026 - Present

- Founded and built an AI-powered athlete supplement intelligence platform, leading product, engineering, and go-to-market end to end
- Shipped full-stack mobile and web products using Claude Code and LLM APIs with modern AI-assisted development workflows
- Integrated wearable and health data with large language models to deliver personalized supplement recommendations and track their impact on athlete performance
- Named Top 5 Finalist in the SEC Startup Competition while growing past 1,000+ downloads, onboarding 2 teams, and converting paying users into recurring subscription revenue

## PROJECTS

### AI Portfolio Optimizer - Independent Project

May 2025 - July 2025

- Built an AI-powered robo-advisor using Python, Plaid APIs, and Monte Carlo simulation to generate personalized ETF portfolios based on investor risk profiles
- Developed machine learning pipelines incorporating alternative financial data and generative AI to automate portfolio recommendations

## LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

### Gamecock Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning

*Active Member*

November 2024 – Present

- Active member building machine learning models and participating in applied AI competitions

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python, SQL, R
- **Machine Learning:** XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, Random Forest, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, SHAP
- **Generative AI:** OpenAI API, Claude API, Prompt Engineering, AI Agents, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)
- **Developer Tools:** Claude Code, Git, GitHub, VS Code, Jupyter
- **Data:** Snowflake, Pandas, NumPy, Feature Engineering, ETL Pipelines
- **Analytics:** Credit Risk Modeling, Predictive Modeling, Information Value (IV), Reject Inference, Calibration, Monte Carlo Simulation, Statistical Analysis
- **Cloud & Platforms:** AWS, Supabase, Railway, Power BI, Excel